SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #101 · GOD'S WILL & GUIDANCE

"If I miss God's perfect will, my life is ruined."

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that God has one exact plan and missing it means settling for second best forever. Regret over a past decision, such as a job, a move, or a marriage. Fear of making the wrong choice. Perfectionism. Hearing people talk about being "out of God's will."

What Scripture teaches

God is sovereign and good, and He is not limited by our mistakes. When the potter's clay was marred, he formed it into another vessel. God works all things together for good for those who love Him, even our poor choices. The LORD will fulfill His purpose for you. A person plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps. Your life is not ruined by one decision; it is in the hands of a faithful God.

> *"And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose"* **(Romans 8:28)**.

Also see

> "But the vessel that he was shaping from the clay became flawed in his hand; so he formed it into another vessel, as it seemed best for him to do" **(Jeremiah 18:4)**.

> "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands" **(Psalm 138:8)**.

> "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps" **(Proverbs 16:9)**.

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" **(Philippians 1:6)**.

Common self-statements

- I made the wrong choice, and now my life is ruined.
- I've missed God's plan forever.
- I'm stuck with second best.
- God can't fix this now.
- If I make the wrong decision, everything is over.
- I'll never get back on track.

Common logical errors

- **Catastrophizing:** Believing one decision has ruined everything.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you are either perfectly in God's will or permanently out of it.
- **Limiting God:** Picturing God as unable to work through your mistakes.
- **Rumination:** Replaying past decisions without moving forward.

Challenging questions

- What did the potter do with the marred vessel?
- Does Romans 8:28 include my mistakes?
- Who will fulfill His purpose for me, according to Psalm 138:8?
- Is God's plan so fragile that I can ruin it?
- What can I learn from the past and do faithfully today?
- Who determines my steps?
- What would change if I trusted God with my past decisions?

Truth summary

> Missing God's best in a decision does not ruin my life. God is not limited by my mistakes. Like a potter reshaping clay, He can form something good from my life. He works all things together for my good and will fulfill His purpose for me. I can learn, repent where needed, and walk faithfully today.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Plans
- Guidance
- Trust
- Hopeless

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I miss God's perfect will, my life is ruined"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I miss God's perfect will, my life is ruined." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did the potter do with marred clay?
- ☐ Does Romans 8:28 include my mistakes?
- ☐ Who will fulfill His purpose for me?
- ☐ Is God's plan so fragile?
- ☐ What can I do faithfully today?
- ☐ Who determines my steps?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is not limited by my mistakes.
- ☐ God works all things together for good.
- ☐ The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ God can reshape my life like a potter.
- ☐ God will finish what He started in me.
- ☐ I can walk faithfully today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 8:28**
  "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose."
- [ ] **Jeremiah 18:4**
  "But the vessel that he was shaping from the clay became flawed in his hand; so he formed it into another vessel, as it seemed best for him to do."
- [ ] **Psalm 138:8**
  "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands."
- [ ] **Proverbs 16:9**
  "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps."
- [ ] **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Faithful today log:** Each day, write one faithful step I took today, without dwelling on past decisions.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 138:8 becomes: "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for **Sarah**. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever—do not abandon the works of Your hands."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Jeremiah 18:1–6,** and write what the potter teaches about God and your life.
- ☐ **Write down a decision you regret,** pray about it, and write one good thing God has done since.
- ☐ **Make one small decision this week** prayerfully and without second-guessing it afterward.
- ☐ **Ask a mature believer** how God worked through a decision they regretted.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I miss God's perfect will, my life is ruined": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One faithful step today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I miss God's perfect will, my life is ruined.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You are not limited by my mistakes. Help me reject the lie that missing Your perfect will has ruined my life. Reshape my life as You see best, work all things together for good, and help me walk faithfully with You today. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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